

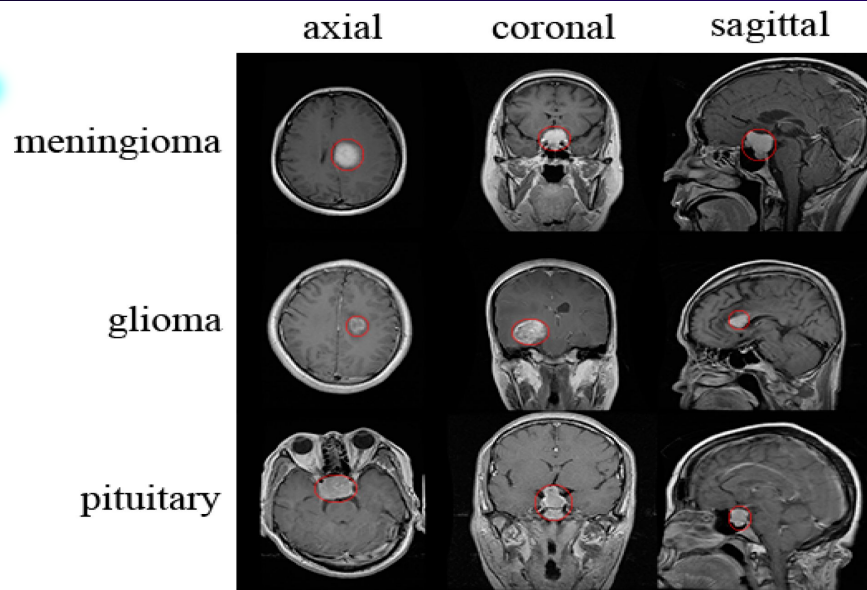
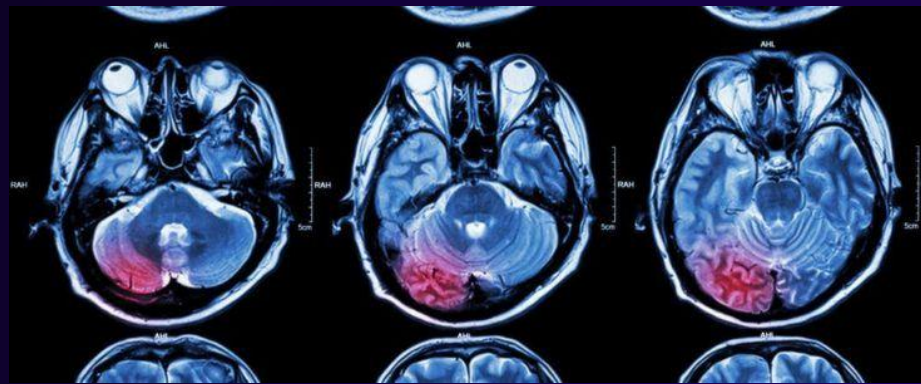
A stylized illustration of a human head in profile, facing right. The head is filled with a blue-to-teal gradient, representing an MRI scan. Inside the head, a red, irregular shape represents a brain tumor. The background is dark blue with several white dots and thin blue lines, suggesting a network or data flow.

# Evaluating Classical Image Processing for **Brain Tumor Segmentation** in MRI Scans

Musa Jawad  
Ahmed Iqbal  
Kenzy Hamed

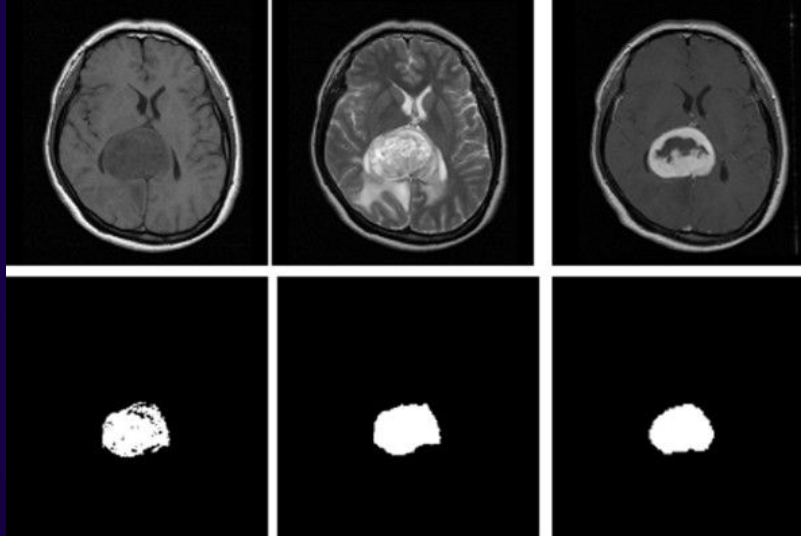
# What are Brain Tumors

- A tumor is an **abnormal growth of cells within your body**. When this growth occurs in the brain, it is called an intracranial tumor, aka brain tumor.
- They are caused by **malfunction in DNA** which causes the cells to continue living, when otherwise a healthy cell would die.
- There are many different types of brain tumors which all **depend on the cells from which the tumor grows from**. Some types are:
  - Gliomas
  - Meningiomas
  - Pituitary Tumor



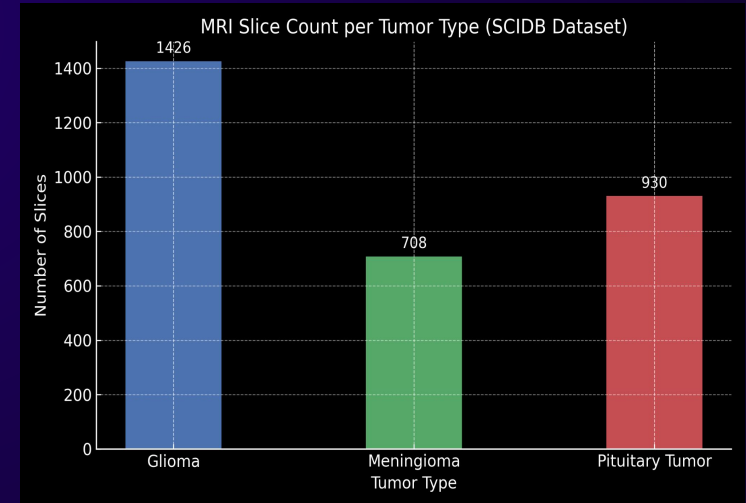
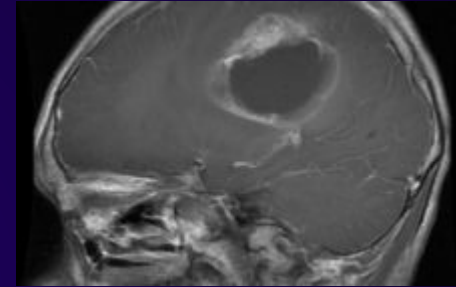
# Our Objective

Our objective is to develop an image processing pipeline which will segment brain tumors from MRI scans.



# Tools & Materials

- Dataset Selection
  - Initially planned to use CBICA (Center for Biomedical Image Computing & Analytics) dataset
  - Instead, we selected a SCIDB Brain Tumour Dataset, better suiting our project
    - Contains 3000+ grayscale MRI images from 233 patients (Glioma, Meningioma, Pituitary)
- Frameworks
  - Python, OpenCV, Tensorflow, Matplotlib, NumPy, scikit-learn



# Method 1- Otsu's Thresholding

- Simple approach
  - No training required
  - Good baseline for tumour segmentation
- Method
  - Otsu's method finds a global threshold, and separates the image to:
    - Bright areas (tumor)
    - Darker areas (brain tissue)
- Results
  - Led to over-segmentation and low Dice scores, but helped us confirm our pipeline



# Method 2: U-Net model

```
Loaded 3964 MRI scans.
Epoch 1/20
613/613 — 12s 28ms/step - accuracy: 0.9668 - loss: 0.1714 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8717
Epoch 2/20
613/613 — 13s 21ms/step - accuracy: 0.9824 - loss: 0.0712 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8721
Epoch 3/20
613/613 — 14s 22ms/step - accuracy: 0.9831 - loss: 0.0689 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8705
Epoch 4/20
613/613 — 14s 22ms/step - accuracy: 0.9823 - loss: 0.0699 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8667
Epoch 5/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9822 - loss: 0.0679 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8649
Epoch 6/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9827 - loss: 0.0649 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8661
Epoch 7/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9823 - loss: 0.0655 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8665
Epoch 8/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9827 - loss: 0.0643 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8629
Epoch 9/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9828 - loss: 0.0635 - val_accuracy: 0.9822 - val_loss: 0.8625
Epoch 10/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9824 - loss: 0.0640 - val_accuracy: 0.9823 - val_loss: 0.8633
Epoch 11/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9823 - loss: 0.0643 - val_accuracy: 0.9825 - val_loss: 0.8607
Epoch 12/20
613/613 — 14s 23ms/step - accuracy: 0.9829 - loss: 0.0618 - val_accuracy: 0.9826 - val_loss: 0.8615
Epoch 13/20
613/613 — 15s 24ms/step - accuracy: 0.9830 - loss: 0.0614 - val_accuracy: 0.9824 - val_loss: 0.8603
Epoch 14/20
613/613 — 15s 25ms/step - accuracy: 0.9831 - loss: 0.0609 - val_accuracy: 0.9826 - val_loss: 0.8626
Epoch 15/20
613/613 — 15s 25ms/step - accuracy: 0.9826 - loss: 0.0625 - val_accuracy: 0.9824 - val_loss: 0.8604
Epoch 16/20
613/613 — 15s 25ms/step - accuracy: 0.9831 - loss: 0.0607 - val_accuracy: 0.9829 - val_loss: 0.8596
Epoch 17/20
613/613 — 14s 22ms/step - accuracy: 0.9825 - loss: 0.0620 - val_accuracy: 0.9830 - val_loss: 0.8598
Epoch 18/20
613/613 — 13s 22ms/step - accuracy: 0.9826 - loss: 0.0616 - val_accuracy: 0.9829 - val_loss: 0.8587
Epoch 19/20
613/613 — 16s 26ms/step - accuracy: 0.9836 - loss: 0.0582 - val_accuracy: 0.9827 - val_loss: 0.8618
Epoch 20/20
613/613 — 13s 21ms/step - accuracy: 0.9823 - loss: 0.0623 - val_accuracy: 0.9827 - val_loss: 0.8608
1/1 — 0s 32ms/step
Dice Score (Sample 0): 0.2734
2025-03-24 21:50:21.613 python[45863:4715264] *IMKClient subclass]: chose IMKClient_Modern
2025-03-24 21:50:21.613 python[45863:4715264] *IMKInputSession subclass]: chose IMKInputSession_Modern
```

INPUT (128x128x1)

└ Conv2D (32 filters) → MaxPooling

└ Conv2D (64 filters)

└ Conv2DTranspose (upsample)

└ Concatenate with earlier conv

└ Conv2D (1x1, sigmoid output)

- Training and validation accuracy (~98%)
- Dice Similarity Coefficient, we obtained a score of 0.2734

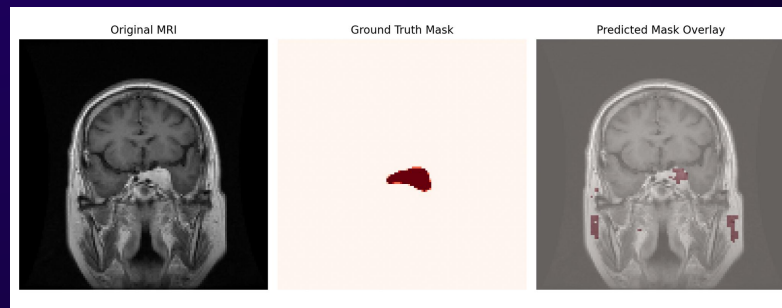
```
def unet_model(input_size=(128, 128, 1)):
    inputs = Input(input_size)

    # Encoder
    conv1 = Conv2D(32, 3, activation='relu', padding='same')(inputs)
    pool1 = MaxPooling2D()(conv1)

    conv2 = Conv2D(64, 3, activation='relu', padding='same')(pool1)

    # Decoder
    up1 = Conv2DTranspose(32, 2, strides=2, padding='same')(conv2)
    merge1 = concatenate([up1, conv1])
    conv3 = Conv2D(1, 1, activation='sigmoid')(merge1)

    model = Model(inputs=inputs, outputs=conv3)
    model.compile(optimizer=Adam(), loss='binary_crossentropy', metrics=['accuracy'])
    return model
```

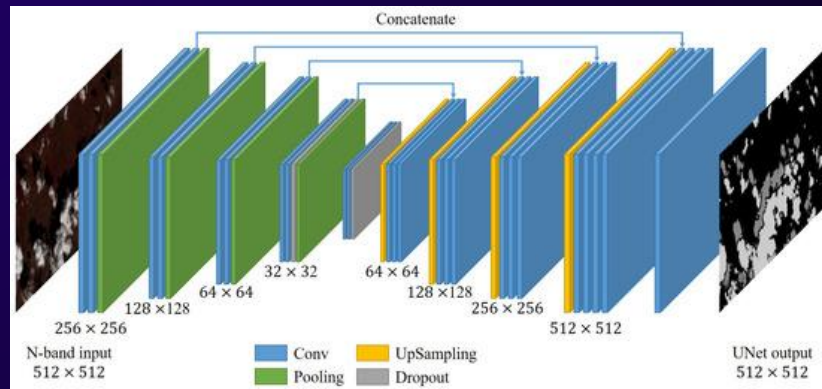
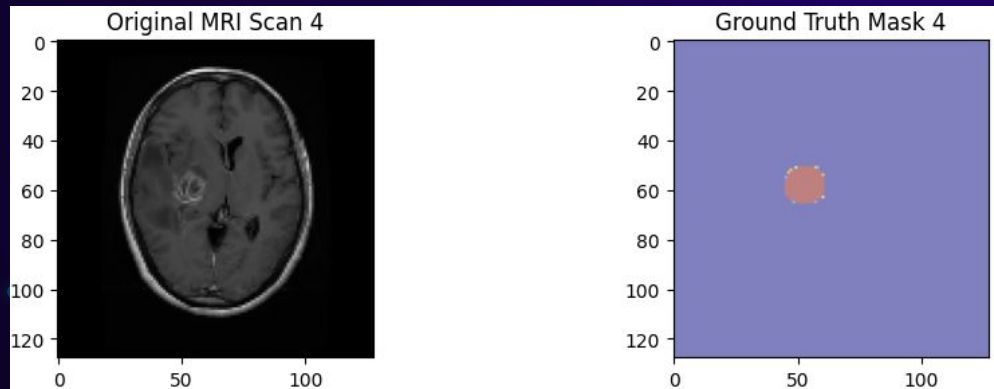




# Method 3 - Final Approach

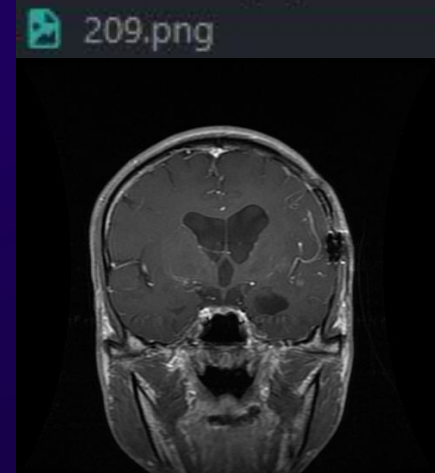
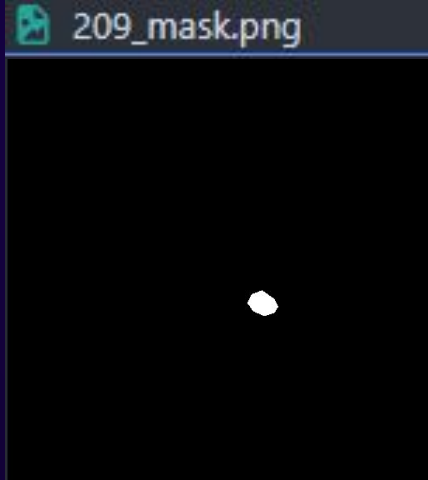
```
def build_model(input_shape=(128, 128, 1)):
    model = Sequential([
        Conv2D(64, (3, 3), activation='relu', padding='same', input_shape=input_shape),
        MaxPooling2D((2, 2)),
        Conv2D(128, (3, 3), activation='relu', padding='same'),
        MaxPooling2D((2, 2)),
        Conv2D(256, (3, 3), activation='relu', padding='same'),
        UpSampling2D((2, 2)),
        Conv2D(128, (3, 3), activation='relu', padding='same'),
        UpSampling2D((2, 2)),
        Conv2D(64, (3, 3), activation='relu', padding='same'),
        Conv2D(1, (1, 1), activation='sigmoid')
    ])
    model.compile(optimizer='adam', loss='binary_crossentropy', metrics=['accuracy'])
    return model
```

- Turn the images greyscale and create a binary mask of it. The pixel = 1 if there is tumor, or 0 otherwise.
- 128 by 128 mask
- U-net Convolutional Neural Network
  - Made in 2015
  - Used for upscaling images, creating masks for images, and generating images
  - Has 2 parts
    - Encoder: Captures the features of the time of the image
    - Decoder: Captures where the item is
    - Combining these 2 can give us a pixel perfect mask of the original object



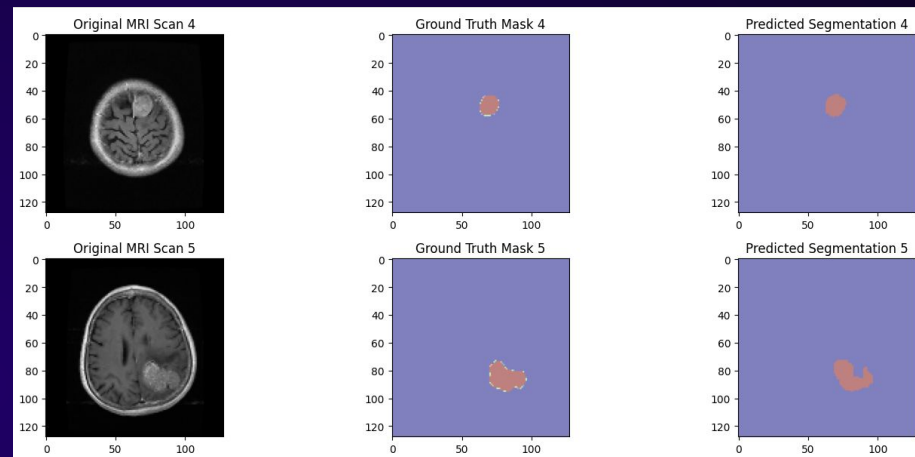
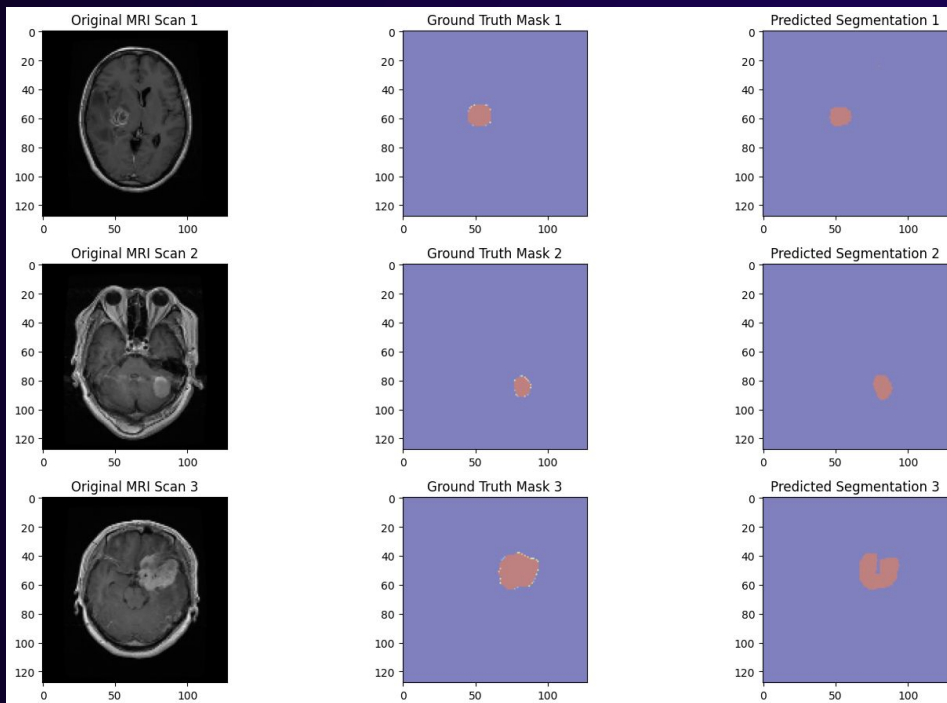
# Method 3 - Final Approach - cont.

- Resize each MRI image to a 128 by 128 pixel image
- Apply grayscale to each image
- Insert image into the U-net model to predict the mask, and then compare to the already given truth mask





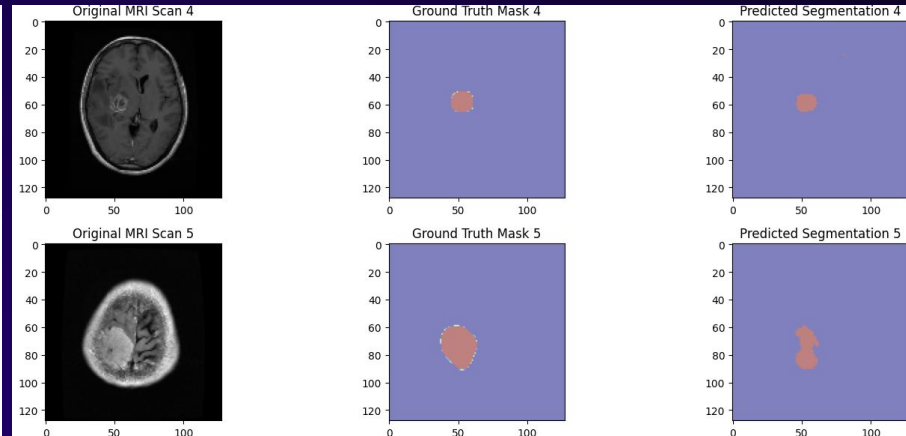
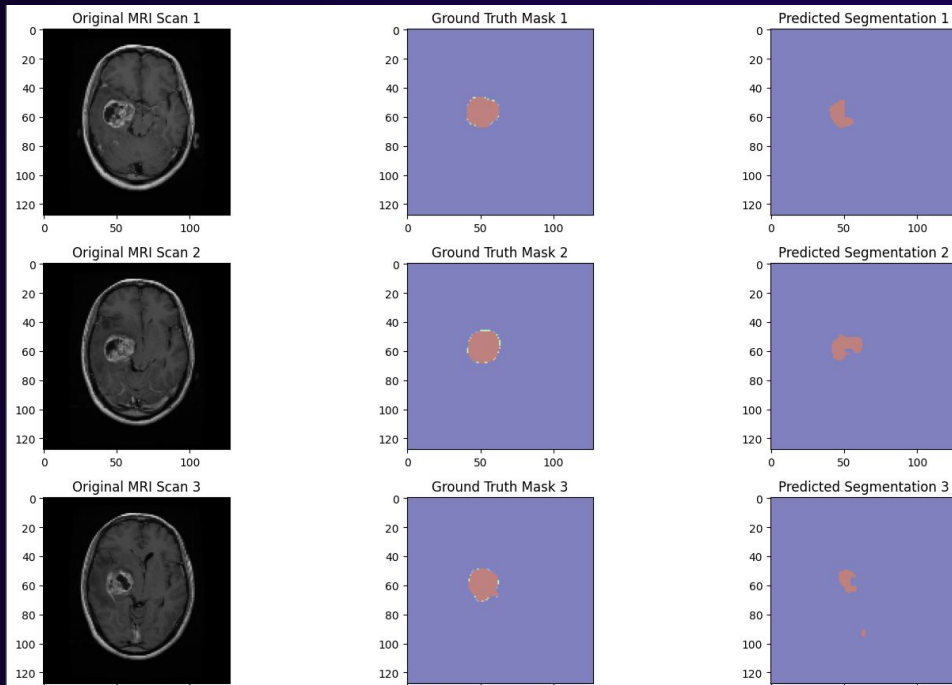
# Our Results



## Metrics

| Example | DSC    | IoU    | Accuracy |
|---------|--------|--------|----------|
| 1       | 0.8700 | 0.7699 | 0.9967   |
| 2       | 0.8656 | 0.7631 | 0.9971   |
| 3       | 0.9159 | 0.8449 | 0.9939   |
| 4       | 0.9328 | 0.8741 | 0.9980   |
| 5       | 0.8620 | 0.7575 | 0.9924   |

# Our Results - Limitations



## Metrics

```
1/1 ————— 0s 108ms/step
Example 1: DSC = 0.6500, IoU = 0.4815
1/1 ————— 0s 24ms/step
Example 2: DSC = 0.7501, IoU = 0.6001
1/1 ————— 0s 26ms/step
Example 3: DSC = 0.5072, IoU = 0.3398
1/1 ————— 0s 24ms/step
Example 4: DSC = 0.8700, IoU = 0.7699
1/1 ————— 0s 25ms/step
Example 5: DSC = 0.7171, IoU = 0.5589
```

# Conclusion & Future Work

## Conclusion:

- Otsu's method wasn't well suited, due to its reliance on global threshold
- Our first U-net model provided high accuracy but did not show the same results for dice score
- The final U-net model was able to accurately learn tumour features/locations, giving us better metrics

## Future:

- Increase IOU Score
- Determine if there is tumor to begin with rather than always assuming there is
- Model Deployment

# Thanks

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